



Creating Flash Games on Linux: An Overview

With the growing popularity of Facebook and game sites like miniclip.com, Flash games have acquired a huge fan base. But here, we'll look at the other side of the coin. Have you ever thought about creating your own Flash games? Now, that's what we are going to tell you about...

It doesn't matter if you have any prior work experience on the Flash platform, or whether you can write a chunk of code or not, because the most exciting part of creating Flash games is that you don't need to write a single line of code. The tool StencylWorks, which we will be using, provides a nice drag-and-drop interface to create games. So get ready for the fun world of game creation.

You can download StencylWorks from its official site's download link <http://www.stencyl.com/stencylworks/get/>. At the bottom of this Web page, you can choose your platform (Windows, Linux or Mac). So simply select Linux and your .tar.gz download will start automatically.

To run StencylWorks, you'll need at least Java 1.6 installed on your system. I'm using RHEL 5, which

provides Java 1.6 in its package library; so a simple `yum install java-1.6*` command did it for me. The same command will work on Fedora too.

If your Linux distribution doesn't include Java 1.6, you will have to download it from <http://www.oracle.com/technetwork/java/javase/downloads/jdk-6u31-download-1501634.html> and install it. I have Ubuntu 9.10 running on VMware, so I downloaded the `linux-i586.bin` package from the page (you can choose an appropriate package for your system's OS and configuration). Now launch the downloaded bin package as the root user to install Java. It will extract the contents of the bin package into a folder named `jdk1.6.0_13` in your home directory; copy or move this folder to `/usr/local`, which is the